

Verified

UEFA Nations League

UEFA introduced the Nations League to replace many international friendlies with competitive league matches. The highest-ranked teams compete for a place in the Nations League Finals.

UEFA Nations League Finals, 2018-19 onward

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
2024-25	Germany	Portugal	Spain	France	Germany	2-2; Portugal 5-3 pens	8 June 2025	▶ Tap to read the story Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition's first two-time champion.

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
<u>2022-23</u>	Netherlands	<u>Spain</u>	Croatia	Italy	Netherlands	0-0; Spain 5-4 pens	18 June 2023	►  Tap to read the story Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
<u>2020-21</u>	Italy	<u>France</u>	Spain	Italy	Belgium	France 2-1 Spain	10 October 2021	►  Tap to read the story Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2-1 for the title.
<u>2018-19</u>	Portugal	<u>Portugal</u>	Netherlands	England	Switzerland	Portugal 1-0 Netherlands	9 June 2019	►  Tap to read the story Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1-0 as hosts.

Podium by edition

2024-25 Hosted by Germany 🏆 Portugal 🥈 Spain 🥉 France 4. Germany	2022-23 Hosted by Netherlands 🏆 Spain 🥈 Croatia 🥉 Italy 4. Netherlands	2020-21 Hosted by Italy 🏆 France 🥈 Spain 🥉 Italy 4. Belgium
2018-19 Hosted by Portugal 🏆 Portugal 🥈 Netherlands 🥉 England 4. Switzerland		

🏆 Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Portugal	2
2018-19, 2024-25	
France	1
2020-21	

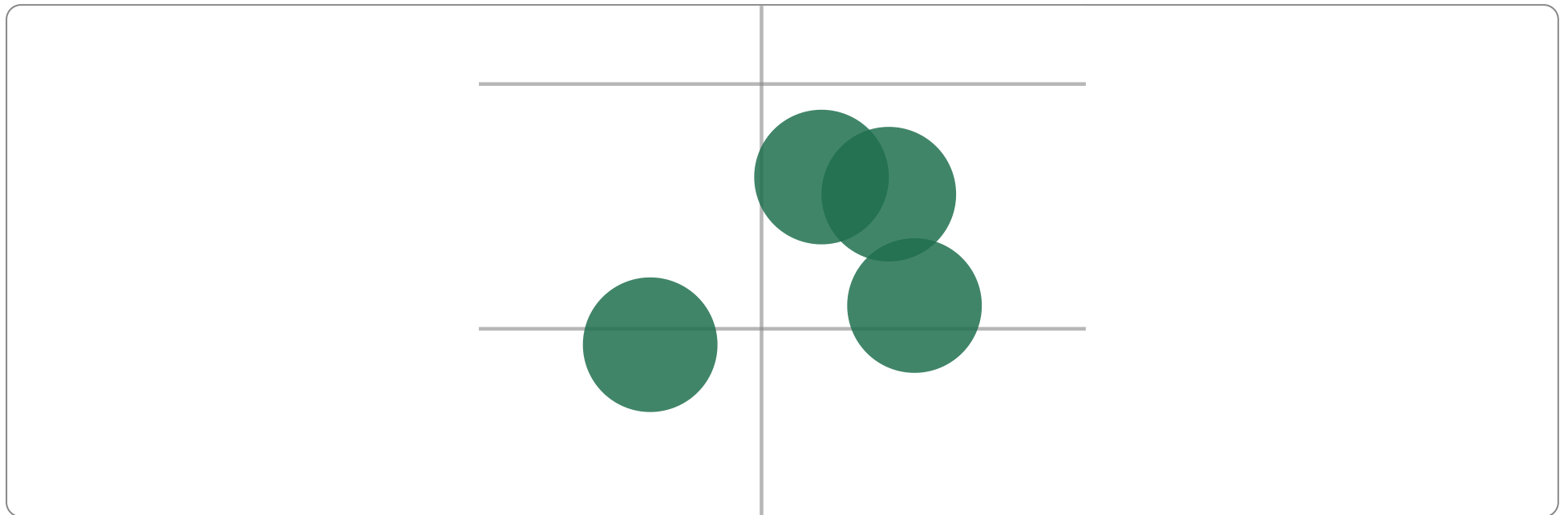
Spain

1

2022-23

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



Europe

Portugal 1 time

2018-19

Italy 1 time

2020-21

Netherlands 1 time

2022-23

Germany 1 time

2024-25

How it works

- Every UEFA national team is placed into one of four leagues (A to D) by strength, then split into small groups within its league.
- Teams play each other in their group; results promote the best teams to a higher league and relegate the weakest to a lower one, alongside separate World Cup/EURO qualifying.
- The four League A group winners advance to the Nations League Finals: two semifinals, a third-place match, and a final, all hosted by one of the four finalists.
- Held every two years.

Key facts

- Portugal won the inaugural edition.
- Portugal became the first two-time champion in 2025.
- Croatia reached its first Nations League final in 2023.
- The competition uses promotion and relegation between leagues.

Player of the Finals winners

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every Nations League Finals since the competition's 2019 launch, initially called "Player of the Tournament" before being renamed "Player of the Finals" from 2021 onward.
- **2019:** Bernardo Silva (Portugal).
- **2021:** Sergio Busquets (Spain).
- **2023:** Rodri (Spain).
- **2025:** Nuno Mendes (Portugal).

Winning managers

- **2019:** Fernando Santos (Portugal).

- **2021:** Didier Deschamps (France).
- **2023:** Luis de la Fuente (Spain) - the same season he took charge of Spain, before also winning EURO 2024 and the 2026 World Cup with them.
- **2025:** Roberto Martínez (Portugal) - his first trophy since taking over from Fernando Santos.



Winning captains

- The captain is the player who lifts the trophy on the podium; every Nations League Finals winner has had one across all four completed editions.
- **2019:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal).
- **2021:** Hugo Lloris (France).
- **2023:** Jordi Alba (Spain) - given the captaincy for the Finals by manager Luis de la Fuente.
- **2025:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal) - the first captain to lift the Nations League trophy twice.



Memorable moments

- Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1–0 as hosts.
- Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2–1 for the title.
- Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
- Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition's first two-time champion.
- The host nation has finished in the Finals' top four in every edition so far, including Germany finishing fourth in 2025.



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 1 September 2026

- UEFA official competition (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/>).
- 2025 champion (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0297-1d5ccb0b6747-d10a8fc4eb86-1000--portugal-meet-the-nations-league-winners/>).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2019_UEFA_Nations_League_final).

- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/540881/netherlands-portugal).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/589985/france-spain).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/654361/spain-croatia).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-03): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0282-1849d8b2412c-f43f87000e15-1000--spain-win-nations-league-croatia-edged-out-on-penalties/>).
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/video/highlights/029a-1df45a93f27a-f9ad891597e4-1000--2025-uefa-nations-league-final-highlights-portugal-2-2-spain/>).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0253-0d821b962b73-720b41ee3a40-1000--england-beat-switzerland-on-penalties-in-nations-league-m/>).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/540882/england-switzerland).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/026e-137218f01734-bf182cc6c45c-1000--italy-2-1-belgium-azzurri-secure-third-place-at-nations-league/>).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/589984).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0282-18494807115a-60db6abfda87-1000--netherlands-2-3-italy-azzurri-claim-third-place-with-thriller/>).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/654362/italy-netherlands).
- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/029a-1df3af7eedc9-c3b6e51cf3f1-1000--germany-vs-france-highlights-and-report-kylian-mbappe-scorer/>).

- Third-place match audit (2026-08-04): the winner, score, and date of each (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_gameld/723737/france-germany).
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2019_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/13958/11738309/switzerland-0-0-england-5-6-on-pens-jordan-pickford-settles-nations-league-third-place-play-off>)
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals)
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (<https://www.thescore.com/seri/news/2201665>).
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals)
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (https://www.sportsmole.co.uk/football/netherlands/uefa-nations-league/result/italy-edge-out-netherlands-to-win-uefa-nations-league-third-place-playoff_516568.html)
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- Third-place match second independent cross-check (2026-08-12, intensive (<https://www.bbntimes.com/society/france-triumphs-over-germany-to-claim-third-place-in-2025-uefa-nations-league>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2019_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (<https://www.cbssports.com/soccer/news/2019-uefa-nations-league-schedule-dates-tv-live-stream-start-times-netherlands-vs-portugal-in-final/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (<https://www.aljazeera.com/sports/2021/10/11/france-beat-spain-to-lift-nations-league-title>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_UEFA_Nations_League_final).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/12904237/croatia-0-0-spain-4-5-on-penalties-dani-carvajal-converts-winning-penalty-as-la-roja-clinch-nations-league-glory>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UEFA_Nations_League_final).

- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-05): a second, (<https://www.euronews.com/2025/06/09/portugal-beats-spain-to-win-the-nations-league>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2019_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0253-0d8200f22e52-053d234ec760-1000--portugal-confirmed-as-nations-league-finals-hosts>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0264-110090fdb7d2-9b65a2e89c6a-1000--nations-league-hosts-confirmed/>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://www.uefa.com/news-media/news/027b-16b46bcb7a2b-ce54df2cb399-1000--netherlands-to-host-2023-uefa-nations-league-finals/>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://www.fotmob.com/news/85kd364vfk5416h3yqlfmsgg8-netherlands-confirmed-to-host-2023-nations-league-finals>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://www.uefa.com/news-media/news/029a-1deb0169b106-2e1771fe5029-1000--welcome-to-the-2025-uefa-nations-league-finals/>).
- had never had a dedicated audit pass before (every prior pass here (<https://allianz-arena.com/en/news/2025/03/allianz-arena-venue-for-uefa-nations-league-final-four>).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.figc.it/en/figc/news/milan-and-turin-candidates-to-host-uefa-nations-league-finals/>).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.insideworldfootball.com/2022/11/29/dutch-host-2023-nations-league-finals-rotterdam-enschede/>).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/nations-league-final-four-to-be-played-in-the-netherlands-1207554>).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.insideworldfootball.com/2025/03/24/germany-host-final-four-uefas-nations-league-june/>).

- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.footboom1.com/en/news/football/2597104-uefa-nations-league-2025-final-phase-kicks-off-in-germany>).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (https://football.fandom.com/wiki/2019_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (https://gropedia.com/page/2021_UEFA_Nations_League_Finals).
- Finals-host second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://bleacherreport.com/articles/2839840-uefa-nations-league-2019-final-portugal-vs-team-schedule-and-preview>).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0253-0d81efc3f60a-0d39c305041d-1000--bernardo-silva-and-frenkie-de-jong-win-nations-league-awards/>).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/026e-13729be1c1c0-e25470c0a0f1-1000--sergio-busquets-named-2021-uefa-nations-league-player-of->).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0282-1849de0ccdf-e28eb8d71909-1000--rodri-named-2023-uefa-nations-league-player-of-the-finals>).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/029a-1df453c49ada-5d8aff31f9c2-1000--nuno-mendes-named-2025-uefa-nations-league-player-of-the-f/>).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.barcablaugranes.com/2021/10/11/22720363/sergio-busquets-named-nations-league-player-of-the-finals>).
- Player of the Finals winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://m.allfootballapp.com/news/EPL/Sergio-Busquets-has-been-named-2021-UEFA-Nations-League-Player-of-the-Finals/2697091>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.topendsports.com/events/soccer/uefa-nations/winners.htm>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/13954/12768875/fernando-santos-steps-down-as-portugal-head-coach-after-world-cup-exit>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.france24.com/en/tv-shows/france-in-focus/20260616-who-is-didier-deschamps-the-france-coach-aiming-for-a-third-world-cup-title>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.squawka.com/us/news/luis-de-la-fuente/>).

- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/articles/portugal-appoint-former-belgium-boss-roberto-martinez-as-fernando-santos-successor>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.squawka.com/us/news/roberto-martinez/>).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/36166/13380437/nations-league-final-portugal-2-2-spain-5-3-pens-cristiano-ronaldo-helps-portugal-to-reclaim-title>).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (<https://www.olympics.com/en/news/emotional-cristiano-ronaldo-reacts-portugal-2025-uefa-nations-league-trophy-win>).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (https://www.espn.in/football/story/_/id/37635382/france-captain-hugo-lloris-announces-retirement-international-football).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (<https://www.football-espana.net/2023/06/10/jordi-alba-did-not-expected-to-be-named-spain-captain-for-uefa-nations-league-finals>).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/45476228/ronaldo-portugal-nations-league-win).
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning" (<https://www.si.com/soccer/cristiano-ronaldo-leads-portugal-to-glory-takeaways-from-nations-league-final>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.